

Introduction to Ecosystems

Read the overview, then answer all five questions in complete sentences when requested.

Ecosystem overview

- An ecosystem includes living organisms and the nonliving parts of their environment.
- Producers, such as green plants, make their own food. Consumers obtain energy by eating plants or other animals.
- Decomposers break down dead material and return nutrients to the environment. Sunlight, water, soil, and temperature are nonliving factors.

1. Identify one living part of an ecosystem.

Answer: _____

2. Define a producer in your own words.

Answer: _____

3. Briefly explain how consumers get energy.

Answer:

4. Explain why decomposers are important to an ecosystem.

Answer:

5. Name two nonliving factors found in an ecosystem.

Answer: _____